



CAMERA

On the rear, the Nothing Phone 4a has a triple camera setup that includes a 50MP primary sensor, an 8MP ultra-wide lens, and a 50MP telephoto.

In daylight, the primary camera captures photos with vibrant colours. The images have a pleasing contrast that makes them social-media-ready. When capturing a human subject, the camera brightens up the subject's face, which can sometimes make the image a bit processed. But, images as a whole come out great with good detail preservation.

Portrait photography is one of the stronger areas for the Phone 4a. The dedicated telephoto lens allows for more natural background blur. The edge detection is also accurate most times, and the bokeh effect is creamy.

The ultra-wide camera performs well, too. The sensor captures images with details and there is not much of a colour shift compared to the main camera.

On the front, Nothing Phone 4a comes with a 32MP selfie camera. The selfies turned out to be natural with a good amount of detail.

PERFORMANCE AND SOFTWARE

Under the hood, the Nothing Phone

4a features the Snapdragon 7s Gen 4 processor. This is paired with up to 12 GB of LPDDR4X RAM and up to 256 GB of UFS 3.1 storage. In day to day usage, the device feels stable and smooth. Now, while I see a bunch of phones in this budget, the beauty of using this particular phone is the solid software optimisation. Fundamentally, it is still very close to stock Android, all while having the proprietary Nothing goodness that doesn't really get in the way to bog down the fluid experience.

That said, I do want to add a couple of bits about the Essential Key. Now, for those who don't know, this button allows you to quickly take notes or access the Essential Space. However, personally, I still don't find it particularly useful. I think it needs some polish, and some more customisation. Maybe, it could be more beneficial if this key was customisable but I guess that defeats the whole purpose of it being here.

But, moving on from the software, let's talk some numbers. I am sure, while the software and hardware optimisation is what really matters and Nothing nails it, there are people who would still want to know how good or bad a phone scores on benchmarks. And

I did run a few of them so that you can have a fair idea.

In Antutu, the Phone 4a achieved a score of about 1.02 million. In Geekbench, it recorded 1,255 in single-core and 3,365 in multi-core score. In the 3DMark Wildlife Extreme test, the Phone 4a scored 1,110, while the CPU throttling test showed stability of 94%.

Going by the benchmarks, one thing's clear that this phone is not for gaming. But, for a mid-range phone, which is not a gaming flagship, I'd again say, the Nothing Phone 4a performs reasonably well for its price.

BATTERY AND CHARGING

The Nothing Phone 4a is equipped with a 5,400mAh battery, which is also the biggest ever battery on a Nothing Phone. But, beyond the spec, this is an all-day phone. It runs cool, the optimisation is good, and the Snapdragon 7s Gen 4 chip isn't the most power-hungry chip, so that really adds to the phone's advantage. In everyday use, the Phone 4a easily lasts through a full day with moderate to heavy use.

VERDICT

Granted, interested buyers could be looking for more raw performance in a phone at this price point. But, for what it offers, and to the audience this device is appealing to, the Nothing Phone 4a feels different in a sea of options and prioritises usability.

—Siddharth Malhotra

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Qualcomm Snapdragon 7s Gen 4 | RAM: 8/12 GB LPDDR4X | Storage: 256 GB UFS 3.1 | Display: 6.78-inch 1.5K LTPS AMOLED | Refresh Rate: 120 Hz | Battery: 5,400 mAh | Charger: 50 W | Camera(Rear): 50 + 50 + 8 MP | Camera (Front): 32 MP | IP rating: IP64

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